

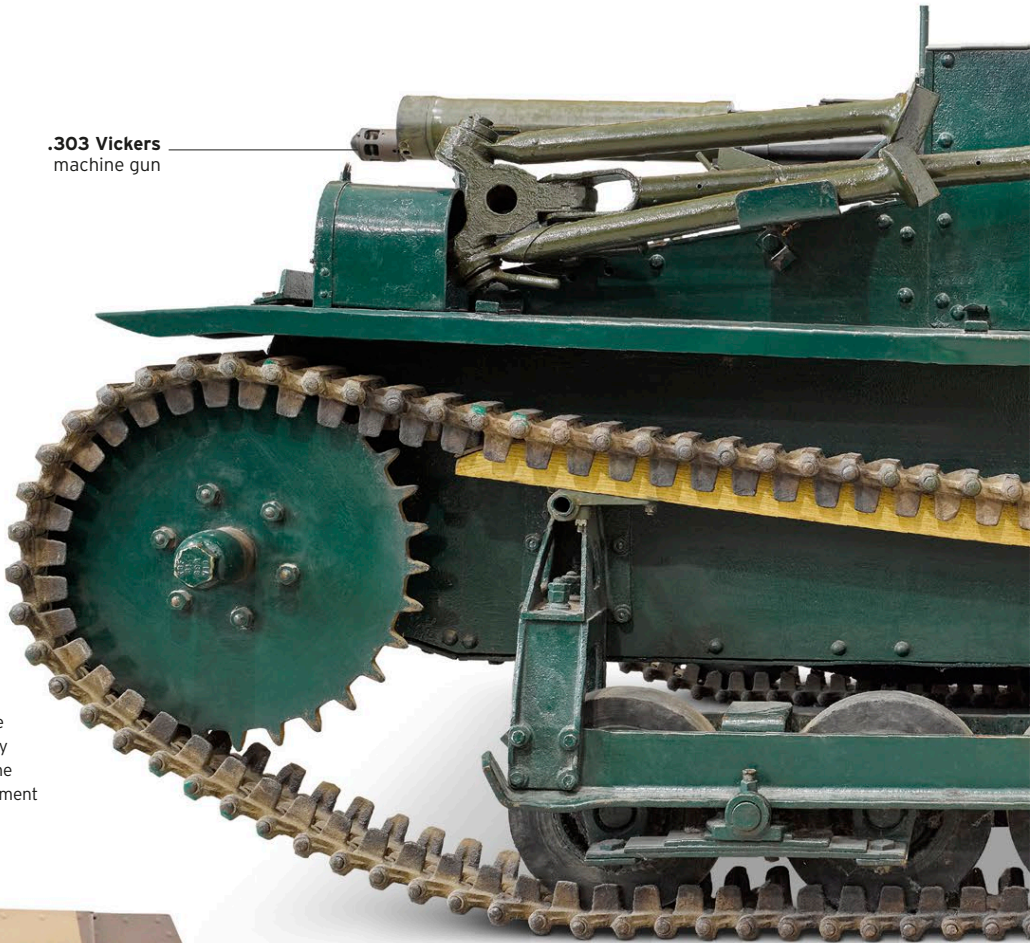
Light Tanks and Tankettes

Military budgets became increasingly stretched as the Great Depression continued throughout the 1930s. Tankettes, a concept that stemmed from the Morris-Martel vehicle, were a relatively cheap way to put a lot of armored firepower onto the battlefield. They were generally used for infantry support and as such became increasingly popular. Light tanks, on the other hand, were larger and better protected, and their role was to take advantage of breakthroughs made by heavier tanks. During this period, most light tanks carried machine guns, antitank guns only appearing toward the end of the 1930s.

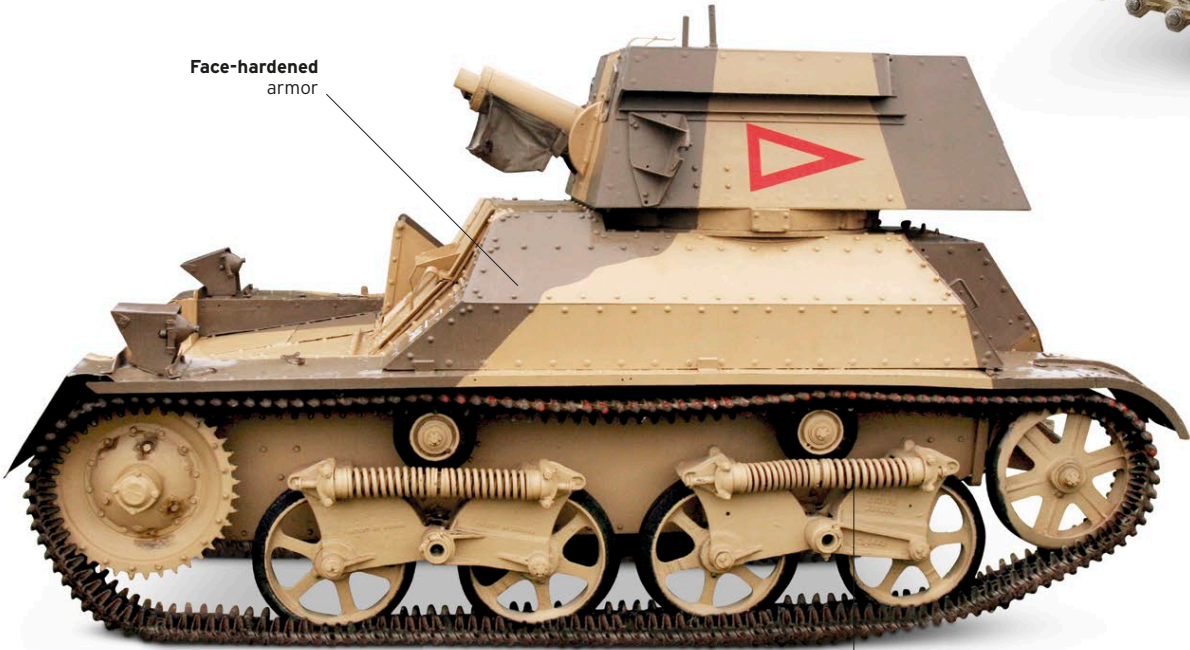
▷ **Carden-Loyd Carrier Mark VI**

Date	1928	Country	UK
Weight	1.7 tons (1.5 tonnes)		
Engine	Ford Model T gasoline, 22.5 hp		
Main armament	.303 Vickers machine gun		

The Carden-Loyd Company built a series of one- and two-man tankettes during the mid 1920s. The Mark VI was the most successful (450 were built by 1935) and it was the last before the company was bought by Vickers. The design was sold around the world, where it influenced the development of many vehicles.



.303 Vickers machine gun



Face-hardened armor

Horstmann suspension system



Light armor aids buoyancy

◁ **T-37A**

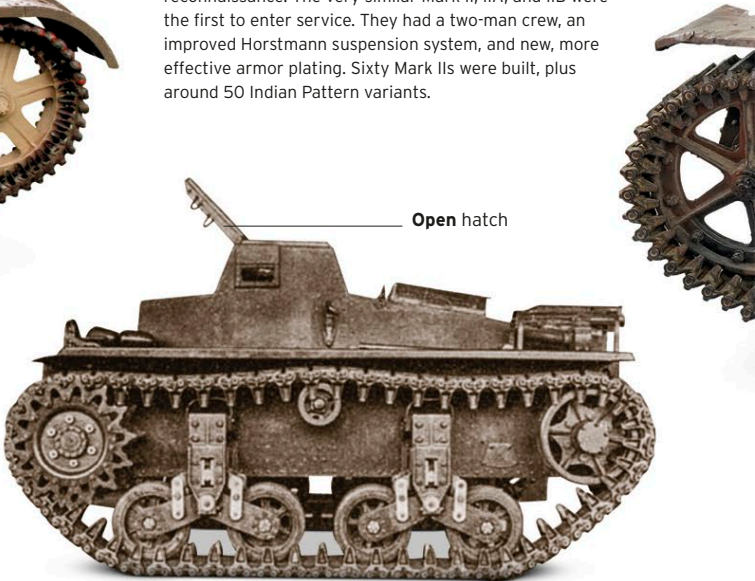
Date	1933	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	3.5 tons (3.2 tonnes)		
Engine	GAZ-AA gasoline, 40 hp		
Main armament	7.62 mm DT machine gun		

The T-37A amphibious tank was developed from the Vickers A4E11, which was sold to the Soviets in 1931. Because of its mobility, it was used for reconnaissance and for infantry support. In order to float it could only be lightly armored, which led to heavy losses when Germany invaded Russia. Around 1,200 were built.

◁ **Vickers Light Tank Mark IIA**

Date	1931	Country	UK
Weight	4.8 tons (4.3 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce 6-cylinder gasoline, 66 hp		
Main armament	.303 Vickers machine gun		

Descended from the Carden-Loyd, the Vickers Light Tank series was intended to replace armored cars for reconnaissance. The very similar Mark II, IIA, and IIB were the first to enter service. They had a two-man crew, an improved Horstmann suspension system, and new, more effective armor plating. Sixty Mark IIs were built, plus around 50 Indian Pattern variants.



Open hatch

△ **Marmon-Herrington CTL-3**

Date	1936	Country	USA
Weight	5 tons (4.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Lincoln V-12 petrol, 110 hp		
Main armament	2 x .30 Browning M1919 machine guns		

The CTL-3 was produced for the US Marine Corps, which imposed a 5-ton weight limit due to shipboard handling limitations. This proved to be a major drawback, and by 1939 it was clear that the US Army's light tanks were superior and that their greater weight was manageable.